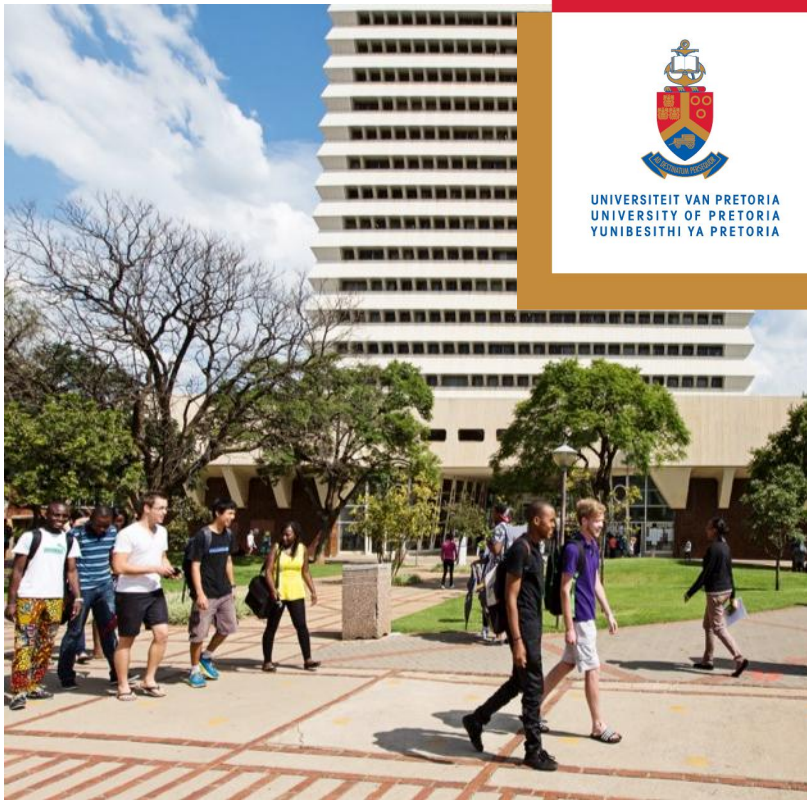




UNIVERSITEIT VAN PRETORIA
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Fakulteit Geesteswetenskappe
Lefapha la Bomo

IsiZulu for Beginners **ZUL 119 Study notes** **Department of African Languages**

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INTRODUCTION: SOME MAIN FEATURES OF ISIZULU

IsiZulu, the language of the Zulu people, is spoken throughout KwaZulu-Natal, the North-eastern Free State, and some areas in Gauteng.

IsiZulu belongs to the Nguni group of South African Bantu languages. The Nguni group includes AmaXhosa and amaSwazi. Ndebele spoken in Matabeleland of Zimbabwe, Ndebele of the Gauteng and Nguni spoken in Malawi are all dialectal forms of isiZulu.

The following are some of the linguistic features of IsiZulu:

1. Nouns are grouped into classes according to their prefixes. The prefixes are indicative of class gender.
2. A word subordinate to a noun must show its agreement with that noun as to class number. The element which brings about this agreement is called a concord.
3. IsiZulu has five vowels, viz. **a e i o u**.
4. IsiZulu is a tone language, i.e., words of different meaning but otherwise identical are differentiated by tone only.
5. Generally, the penultimate syllable of a Zulu word is lengthened.
6. IsiZulu employs click sounds. There are three main important click sounds in isiZulu, i.e. **c, q, and x**.

ISIFUNDO 1: THE SPEECH SOUNDS OF ZULU

PRONOUNCIATION

a	idada	(duck)	is pronounced as in English “ ark ”.
b	ubaba	(father)	is pronounced with implosion.
bh	bhala	(write)	is pronounced as in English “ bed ”.
c	see discussion below		
d	idada	(duck)	is pronounced as in English “ duck ”.
e	bheka	(look)	it is pronounced as in English “ bed ”.
f	ifu	(cloud)	it is pronounced as in English “ fun ”.
g	ugogo	(grandma)	is pronounced as in English “ go ”.
h	hamba	(go)	is pronounced as in English “ hand ”.
i	siza	(help)	is pronounced as in English “ ease ”.
j	uju	(honey)	is pronounced as in English “ Jack ”.
k	umakoti	(bride)	is a sound between English “ k ”. and “ g ”.
	ukuza	(to come)	
kh	ikhanda	(head)	is pronounced as “ c ” in English but more fully aspirated.
l	lala	(sleep)	is pronounced as in English “ laugh ”.
m	umama	(mother)	
n	unina	(mother)	
o	lola	(sharpen)	is pronounced as in English “ law ”.
p	upelepele	(pepper)	is pronounced as in English “ speech ”.
ph	pheka	(cook)	is pronounced as “ p ” in English “ pet ” but more fully aspirated.
q	see discussion below		
r	uprofesa	(professor)	

this sound is not a natural Zulu speech sound and often appears in borrowed words often replaced with l.

s	isisu	(stomach)	is pronounced as in English “ say ”.
sh	ishumi	(ten)	is pronounced as in English “ shall ”.
t	itiye	(tea)	
th	thatha	(take)	is pronounced as “ t ” in English but more fully aspirated.
u	umuzi	(village)	is pronounced as in English “ pool ”.
v	vala	(close)	is pronounced as in English “ van ”.
w	iwele	(twin)	is pronounced as in English “ wall ”.
x	see discussion below		
y	uyise	(father)	is pronounced as in English “ yes ”.
z	zama	(try)	

Combinations of sounds

ng	ingane	(child)	is pronounced as in English “ finger ”.
nk	inkinga	(problem)	is pronounced as in English “ wink ”.
ny	inyoni	(bird)	is pronounced as in “ Vignette ”.
tsh	utshani	(grass)	is pronounced as in English “ chin ”.

hl **hlala** (sit/reside)

Place the front part of your tongue against the roof of your mouth behind the front teeth and then force out the air at the sides of the mouth to make a hissing sound.

Note: there is no s in front of hl!

dl **dlala** (play)

Place the front part of your tongue against the roof of your mouth behind the front teeth and then force out the air at the sides of the mouth to make a hissing sound, simultaneously producing voice in your throat.

kl **klwebha** (scratch)

Raise the back of the tongue against the soft palate. Keep the front part of the tongue down behind the lower teeth. Force air through the closure caused by raising the back of the tongue against the soft palate.

CLICK SOUNDS

There are three basic clicks in Zulu.

C To pronounce this sound:

Place the tip of your tongue against the back of your top front teeth and pull the tongue down sharply to make a sucking sound (that sounds like the sound you often make when you want to express pity – usually written as “tut-tut” in English).

c **cula** (sing)

ch **chaza** (explain)

nc **ncane** (small)

gc **gcina** (end)

ngc **ngcono** (better)

Q To pronounce this sound:

Curl your tongue backwards, place the front part against the middle part of the roof of your mouth, and then pull your tongue down sharply to make a clicking sound (that resembles the sound which a cork makes when you draw it from a bottle).

q **qala** (start)

qh **qhaqhazela** (tremble)

nq **nqoba** (defeat)

gq **gqoka** (wear)

ngq **ngqongqoza** (knock)

X To pronounce this sound:

Keep your tongue still against the roof of your mouth and suck in air through the sides of your mouth simultaneously making a clicking sound at the back of your mouth (that resembles the sound that a rider makes to urge on a horse) – a sideways click.

x	<i>xoxa</i>	(chat, discuss)
xh	<i>isiXhosa</i>	(the Xhosa language)
nx	<i>nxese</i>	(sorry)
gx	<i>gxuma</i>	(jump)
ngx	<i>ingxoxo</i>	(discussion)

Practise saying the words.

<i>-funda</i>	(read)	<i>abafana</i>	(boys)
<i>-bhala</i>	(write)	<i>-cula</i>	(sing)
<i>-chitha</i>	(spill)	<i>-gcwalisa</i>	(fill up)
<i>-ncane</i>	(small)	<i>-ngcolile</i>	(be dirty)
<i>idada</i>	(duck)	<i>-letha</i>	(bring)
<i>-thengile</i>	(bought)	<i>-funda</i>	(learn, read)
<i>-gula</i>	(be sick)	<i>-hamba</i>	(go, travel)
<i>-hlamba</i>	(wash, swim) (v)	<i>-biza</i>	(call) (v)
<i>ijezi</i>	(jersey)	<i>ukudla</i>	(food)
<i>-khala</i>	(cry) (v)	<i>-lambile</i>	(be hungry)
<i>masisha</i>	(quickly)	<i>-na</i>	(rain) (v)
<i>-ngena</i>	(enter)	<i>inyama</i>	(meat)
<i>-thola</i>	(get)	<i>-khombisa</i>	(show)
<i>-penda</i>	(paint) (v)	<i>phandle</i>	(outside)
<i>-qeda</i>	(finish)	<i>-qhotha</i>	(stoop, bend)
<i>ngoMgqibelo</i>	(on Saturday)	<i>-nqoba</i>	(defeat)
<i>-ngqongqoza</i>	(knock)	<i>irandi</i>	(rand)

-sebenza	(work) (v)	-shisa	(burn) (v)
itafula	(table)	-thatha	(take) (v)
-tshela	(tell)	-funa	(want)
-vula	(open) (v)	unyawo	(foot)
-xosha	(chase away)	ixhegu	(old man)
-gxuma	(jump) (v)	ingxoxo	(conversation)
nxephe	(sorry!)	yebo	(yes)
-zama	(try) (v)		

Say the following sentence which makes good use of the **X** click:

Ixoxo liyagxumagxuma. 'The bullfrog is jumping.'

Amaxoxo ayaxokozela exoxa ngoxamu exhibeni. "The frogs are talking loudly about the monitor lizard."

Say the following sentence which makes good use of the **Q** click:

Iqaqa liqhaqhazela emgwaqeni. 'The polecat is shivering in the road.'

Say the following sentence which makes good use of the **C** click:

UCele ucambalele ocansini ucabanga ngecebo lokuciba ucilo ngomcibilisholo. "Mr Cele is lying on a grass mat thinking about a plan to hurl a spear at a lark."

GREETING IN ZULU

One person greeting one other person:

A

Sawubona! (Hello!)

Unjani? (How are you?)

B

Yebo, sawubona! (Yes, hello!)

Ngikhona.

Ngiyaphila. (I am fine)

Ngisaphila.

Wena unjani? (How are you?)

Nami ngikhona.

Nami ngiyaphila. (I am also fine).

Nami ngisaphila.

One person greeting a number of other people:

A

San'bonani! (Hello!)

Ninjani? (How are you?)

B

Yebo, sawubona! (Yes, good day!)

Sikhona.

Siyaphila. (We are fine).

Sisaphila.

Wena unjani? (How are you?)

Nami ngikhona.

Nami ngiyaphila. (I am also fine)

Nami ngisaphila.

Respectful greeting

When you greet a very senior person or someone in a position of power that you respect, you can use the plural greeting instead of the singular.

A (Themba Dlomo)

San'bonani, Dokotela Ntuli!

(Good day, Doctor Ntuli!)

Ninjani? (How are you?)

Nami ngikhona. (I am also fine.)

B (Doctor Ntuli)

Yebo, sawubona! (Yes, good day!)

Ngikhona. Wena unjani? (I am fine. How are you?)

Modes of address

When greeting, it is important to use the correct form to address the person that you are speaking to.

Senior woman (informal)

Sawubona mama! (umama)

Senior male person (Mr) (informal)

Sawubona baba! (ubaba)

Senior woman (Mrs) (formal)

Sawubona Nkosikazi! (inkosikazi)

Miss

Sawubona Nkosazana! (inkosazana)

Senior male person (formal)

Sawubona Mnumzane! (umnumzane)

Children

San'bonani bantwana! (abantwana)

Two women who know each other well.

Sawubona dade(wethu)! /sisi! (udadewethu/usisi)

Two men who know each other well.

Sawubona mfowethu! bhuti! (umfowethu/ ubhuti)

Students

San'bonani bafundi! (abafundi)

Professor

Sawubona profesa! (uprofesa)

Teacher

Sawubona thisha! (uthisha)

Doctor

Sawubona dokotela! (udokotela)

Boys

San'bonani bafana! (abafana)

Girls

San'bonani mantombazana! (a)mantombazana)

John

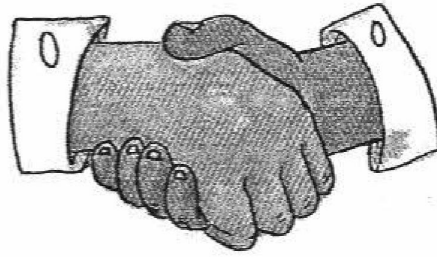
Sawubona John! (uJohn)

THE AFRICAN HANDSHAKE

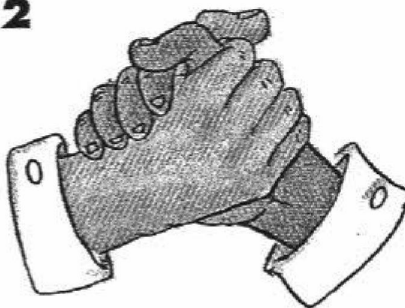
Comprises of three hand movements:

1. Traditional handshake
2. Clasping of thumbs
3. Traditional handshake

1



2



3



SAYING GOODBYE IN ZULU

Saying goodbye in Zulu also follows a fixed pattern, depending on who is leaving and who is staying behind.

One person saying goodbye to one other person:

A (Person leaving)

Sala kahle! (Goodbye! Stay well!)

B (Person staying behind)

Hamba kahle! (Goodbye! Go well!)

A (Person staying behind)

Hamba kahle! (Goodbye! Go well!)

B (Person leaving)

Sala kahle! (Goodbye! Stay well!)

One person saying goodbye to a number of other people:

A (Person staying behind)

Hambani kahle! (Goodbye! Go well!)

B (People leaving)

Sala kahle! (Goodbye! Stay well!)

A (Person leaving)

Salani kahle! (Goodbye! Stay well!)

B (People staying)

Hamba kahle! (Goodbye! Go well!)

Saying “please” and “thank you” in Zulu:

Ngiyabonga (Thank you)

Nami ngiyabonga (I too say thank you) or ***Kubonga mina***.

Ngingajabula (Yes, please – lit. I would be glad/happy)

ZULU CUSTOMS (AMASIKO)

EYE CONTACT

A child is taught to look down when addressing his elders, to speak quietly and to speak only when spoken to. An avoidance of direct eye contact (apart from an occasional quick glance to show that you have his attention) must therefore not be mistaken as a sign of shiftiness or guilt.

UMSEBENZI WASEKHAYA (Homework 1) - Greeting in Zulu

Complete the following greetings by filling in the gaps:

a) One person greeting one other person:

A

Sawubona (Hello!)

_____? (How are you?)

_____ ngikhona. (I am also fine.)

B

Yebo, sawubona! (Yes, hello!)

_____, wena _____? (I am fine. How are you?)

b) One person greeting several other people (typical hospital situation)

A (Doctor)

_____! (Hello!)

_____? (How are you?)

Nami _____ (I am also fine.)

B (Patients)

_____, _____ Dokotela! (Yes, good day, doctor!)

_____. Wena _____? (We are fine. How are you?)

c) Respectful greeting

A (Themba Dlomo)

Sanibonani, Dokotela Ntuli!

(Good day, Doctor Ntuli!)

Ninjani? (How are you?)

Nami *ngiyaphila* (I am also fine.)

B (Dokotela Ntuli)

Yebo, *sawubona*! (Yes, good day!)

Ngikona wena, unjani? (I am fine. How are you?)

d) Thank you and goodbye to one person

ngiyabonga bonga. (I thank you)

Sala *kahle.* (Stay well)

Hamba *kahle.* (Go well.)

ISIFUNDO 2: GIVING INSTRUCTIONS IN ZULU (COMMANDS)

Some action words (verbs) of isiZulu:

walk	<i>hamba</i>
run	<i>gijima</i>
sit down	<i>hlala phansi.</i>
speak	<i>khuluma</i>
eat	<i>dla</i>
drink	<i>phuza</i>
listen	<i>lalela</i>
keep quiet	<i>thula</i>
enter	<i>ngena</i>
go out	<i>phuma</i>
read / learn	<i>funda</i>
write	<i>bhala</i>
sleep	<i>lala</i>
wash	<i>geza</i>
cut	<i>sika</i>
watch	<i>bheka</i>
play	<i>dlala</i>
think	<i>cabanga</i>
take	<i>thatha</i>
work	<i>sebenza</i>
use	<i>sebenzisa</i>
see	<i>bona</i>
start	<i>qala</i>
finish	<i>qeda</i>
hurry up	<i>shesha</i>
repeat	<i>phinda</i>
rest	<i>phumula</i>
remember	<i>khumbula</i>
hit	<i>shaya</i>
cleanse	<i>hlanza</i>
get up	<i>phakama</i>
bend over	<i>goba</i>
stretch	<i>elula</i>
exercise	<i>vivinya</i>
wake up	<i>vuka</i>
relax	<i>khululeka</i>
put on	<i>faka</i>

gossip	hleba	
get better		lulama
cry		khala
try		zama
be ill		gula
stand up		sukuma
wait		linda
wait for		lindela
help		siza
get dressed		gqoka
undress		khumula
take out		khipha
want / look for		funa
be careful		qaphela
bring		letha
open		vula
close		vala
pick up		cosha
put down		beka phansi
call		biza
ask		buza
answer		phendula
tell		tshela
throw away		lahla
touch		thinta
come		za
go		ya
smoke		bhema
cook		pheka
throw		phonsa
like / love		thanda
buy		thenga
request		cela
examine		hlola
get on to		khwela
get off	ehla	
stop		yeka
remove		susa
untie / loosen	khulula	
treat		elapha

Giving positive strong instructions in the affirmative to one person:

When giving a strong positive instruction to one person we merely use the Zulu verb as is, in its original form, with an intonation designating a command.

<i>Lalela!</i>	(Listen!)
<i>Hlala phansi!</i>	(Sit down!)
<i>Sukuma!</i>	(Stand up!)
<i>Thula!</i>	(Keep quiet!)

When we use a verb that has only one syllable to give an instruction, we must add a **yi-** to the front of the verb.

<i>Yidla ukudla!</i>	Eat the food!
<i>Yima lapha!</i>	Stand here!

When giving instructions to more than one person: we add **-ni** to the verb. The function of this **-ni** is to indicate that the instruction is given to more than one person. It is therefore called a **plural marker**.

Giving instructions in the affirmative to many people:

<i>Lalelani!</i>	Listen, both/all of you!
<i>Hlalani phansi!</i>	Sit down, both/all of you!
<i>Sukumani!</i>	Stand up, both/all of you!
<i>Thulani!</i>	Keep quiet, both/all of you!

Compare also:

<i>Yidlani ukudla!</i>	Eat the food, both/all of you!
-------------------------------	--------------------------------

How to make polite requests in Zulu

• To one person

When you want to ask politely, or make a request to one person, put **Awu-** (or sometimes **Mawu-**) in front of the verb, and replace the final **-a** of the verb with an **-e**.

<i>Awuphinde</i>	(verb = -phinda) Please repeat
-------------------------	--

Awuthule (verb = **-thula**) Please be quiet

Awusukume (verb = **-sukuma**) Please stand/get up

• To two or more people

When you want to ask politely, or make a request to two or more people, put **Ani-** in front of the verb, and replace the final -a of the verb with an **-e**.

Aningene (verb = **-ngena**) Please come in, both/all of you

Anihambe (verb = **-hamba**) Please go/leave, both/all of you

Anihlale phansi (verb = **-hlala**) Please sit down, both/all of you

Giving instructions in the negative to one person:

When telling somebody not to do something, we need to make some changes to the verb that is used in the instruction. When giving an instruction in the negative to one person (telling somebody not to do something), we need to:

- Add the word for you (sing.), **U-** to the front of the verb
- Add the negative marker **-nga-** after the word for you (sg.), **U-**
- Change the verb ending **-a** to **-i**. (Notice that verbs in Zulu usually end in **-a**.)

Affirmative Negative Meaning

Khuluma! (Talk!) **Ungakhulumi!** Do not talk!

Hlala phansi! (Sit down!) **Ungahlali phansi!** Do not sit down!

Sukuma! (Stand up!) **Ungasukumi!** Do not stand up!

Giving instructions in the negative to two or more people:

When giving an instruction in the negative to two or more people (telling them not to do something), we need to:

- Add the word for **you (plural)**, **Ni-** to the front of the verb
- Add the negative marker **-nga-** after the word for **you (pl.)**, **Ni-**
- Take away the **-ni** at the end of the verb. Since the **Ni-** is already an indication of the plural, the **-ni** at the end is no longer necessary.

- Change the verb ending **-a** to **-i**

Affirmative Negative Meaning

Khulumani! (Talk, all of you!)

Ningakhulumi! Do not talk,
both/all of you!

Hlalani phansi! (Sit down, all of you!)

Ningahlali phansi! Do not sit down,
both/all of you!

Sukumani! *Stand up, all of you!)

Ningasukumi! Do not stand up,
both/all of you

LEARN THE FOLLOWING VERY USEFUL ZULU COMMANDS

Open your mouth wide

Khamisa kakhulu

Take the medicine

Thatha umuthi

Swallow the pills

Gwinya amaphilisi

Take an x-ray

Thatha i-eksireyi

Lie down

Lala phansi

Lie on your back

Lala ngomhlane

Lie on your stomach

Lala ngesisu

Lie on your side

Lala ngohlangothi

Breathe in

Donsa umoya

Breathe out

Khipha umoya

Take off your clothes

Khumula izingubo

Put on the gown

Gqoka igawuni

Stay in bed

Hlala embhedeni

Urinate into the bottle

Chamela ebhodleleni

Wash your hands

Geza izandla

Do not be scared

Ungesabi (-esaba)

Do not blink

Ungaqwayizi (-qwayiza)

Do not move

Unganyakazi (-nyakaza)

Do not cough

Ungakhwehleli (-khwehlela)

Do not worry

Ungakhathazeki (-khathazeka)

LEARN THE FOLLOWING FEW ADVERBS WHICH CAN BE USED WITH INSTRUCTIONS:

<i>kakhulu</i>	‘greatly / very much / a lot’
<i>kancane</i>	‘a little / slightly / slowly’
<i>kahle</i>	‘well / beautifully / nicely’
<i>kamnandi</i>	‘nicely / pleasantly / sweetly’
<i>kanje</i>	‘like this / in this manner’
<i>manje</i>	‘now’
<i>lapha</i>	‘here’
<i>futhi</i>	‘again’

UMSEBENZI WASEKHAYA (Homework 1)- Commands

Express the following phrases as friendly, positive commands, as per the examples provided.

	A-Singular	B- Plural
<i>Biza umfana!</i> (call the boy!)	<i>Awubize umfana.</i>	<i>Anibize umfana.</i>
<i>Funda incwadi</i> (read the book!)	Awufunde incwadi	Awufunde incwadi
<i>Siza abazali!</i> (help the parents!)	Awusize abazali	Anisize abazali
<i>Landa amanzi!</i> (fetch the	Awulande amanzi	Anilande amanzi

water!)		
Yenza itiye! (make tea!)	Ungenzi itiye	Ningenzi itiye
Thula! (be quiet!)	Ungathuli	Anathuli

Express the following phrases as negative commands, as per the examples provided.

	A-Singular	B-Plural
Annie, sebenza! (Annie, work!)	Annie, ungasebenzi!	Annie, ningasebenzi!
Gwinya amaphilisi! (swallow pills!)	Ungagwinyi amaphilisi	Ningagwinyi amaphilisi
Phuza amanzi! (drink water!)	Ungaphuzi amanzi	Ningaphuzi amanzi
Bhala! (write!)		
Letha ukudla! (bring food!)		
Khuluma! (speak!)		

ISIFUNDO 3-NAMES AND SURNAMES IN ZULU

What is your name? *(Li)Ngubani igama lakho? /*

Igama lakho ngubani?

Answers: **My name is James/ I am James**

Igama lami nguJames (My name is James),

Igama lami nguMbalenhle (My name is Mbalenhle) or

NginguJames (I am James),

NginguMbalenhle (I am Mbalenhle)

What is your surname? *(Si)Ngubani isibongo sakho? /*

Isibongo sakho ngubani?

James who? *James bani?*

Mbalenhle who? *Mbalenhle bani?*

Answers:

My surname is Harris/ it is Harris

Isibongo sami nguHarris / nguHarris.

My surname is Ndlovu/ it is Ndlovu

Isibongo sami nguNdlovu/ nguNdlovu.

Who are you? *(Wena) Ungubani?*

=I am James Harris *NginguJames Harris.*

=I am Mbalenhle Ndlovu *NginguMbalenhle Ndlovu.*

=I am Ms Mazibuko *Ngingunkosazana Mazibuko.*

=I am Professor White

NginguProfesa White.

Pleased to meet you!

Kumnandi ukukwazi! / Ngijabulela ukukwazi!

SOME MORE VOCABULARY – LEARN THESE ZULU NOUNS

CLOTHING- IZINGUBO

dress	<i>ilokwe</i>
jersey	<i>ijezi</i>
coat	<i>ijazi</i>
jacket	<i>ibhantshi</i>
shoes	<i>izicathulo</i>
socks	<i>amasokisi</i>
tie	<i>uthayi</i>
gown	<i>igawuni</i>
pyjamas	<i>amaphijama</i>
belt	<i>ibhande</i>
trousers	<i>ibhulukwe</i>
shirt	<i>ihembe</i>
blouse	<i>ishethi</i>
skirt	<i>isiketi</i>
hat	<i>isigqoko</i>
t-shirt	<i>isikibha</i>
shorts	<i>isikhindi</i>
panty	<i>iphenti</i>
underpants	<i>i-andapenti</i>
bra	<i>ubra / ubhodisi</i>

FOOD – UKUDLA

porridge	<i>iphalishi</i>
sugar	<i>ushukela</i>
milk	<i>ubisi</i>
bread	<i>isinkwa</i>
meat	<i>inyama</i>
vegetables	<i>imifino</i>
fruit	<i>izithelo</i>
salt	<i>usawoti</i>
pepper	<i>upelepele</i>
butter	<i>ibhotela</i>

cheese	<i>ushizi</i>
coffee	<i>ikhofi</i>
tea	<i>itiye</i>
water	<i>amanzi</i>
beer	<i>ubhiya</i>
wine	<i>iwayini</i>
cooldrink	<i>icooldrinki</i>
eggs	<i>amaqanda</i>
sweets	<i>amaswidi</i>
biscuits	<i>amabhisikidi</i>

VARIOUS WORDS

table	<i>itafula</i>
chair	<i>isihlalo / isitulo</i>
book	<i>ibhuku / incwadi</i>
paper	<i>iphepha</i>
pen	<i>ipeni</i>
pencil	<i>impensele</i>
bed	<i>umbhede</i>
bag	<i>isikhwama</i>
umbrella	<i>isambulela</i>
keys	<i>izikhiye</i>
watch	<i>iwashi</i>
cellphone	<i>iselula</i>
medicine	<i>umuthi</i>
money	<i>imali</i>

U

THE BODY - UMZIMBA

head	<i>ikhanda</i>
ear	<i>indlebe (izindlebe)</i>
eye	<i>iso (amehlo)</i>
face	<i>ubuso</i>
mouth	<i>umlomo</i>
tongue	<i>ulimi</i>
neck	<i>intamo</i>
nose	<i>ikhala</i>
hand	<i>isandla (izandla)</i>
wrist	<i>isihlakala (izihlakala)</i>

knee	<i>idolo (amadolo)</i>
heart	<i>inhliziyo</i>
liver	<i>isibindi</i>
lung	<i>iphaphu (amaphaphu)</i>
kidney	<i>inso (izinso)</i>
muscle	<i>umsipha (imisipha)</i>
back	<i>umhlane</i>
buttocks	<i>izinqe</i>
chest	<i>isifuba</i>
shoulder	<i>ihlombe (amahlombe)</i>
stomach	<i>isisu</i>
arm	<i>ingalo (izingalo)</i>
elbow	<i>indololwane</i>
leg	<i>umlenze (imilenze)</i>
calf	<i>isihluzi</i>
foot	<i>unyawo (izinyawo)</i>
ankle	<i>iqakala (amaqakala)</i>
hip	<i>inqulu</i>
blood	<i>igazi</i>
vein / artery	<i>umthambo (imithambo)</i>
brain	<i>ubuchopho</i>
skin	<i>isikhumba</i>

A FEW PROFESSIONS

nurse	<i>unesi / umhlengikazi</i>
patient	<i>isiguli</i>
doctor	<i>udokotela</i>
surgeon	<i>udokotela wokuhlinza</i>
herbalist	<i>inyanga</i>
matron	<i>umatroni</i>
sister	<i>usista</i>

chemist	<i>umkhemisi</i>
dietician	<i>isazi semithetho yokudla</i>
radiographer	<i>isisebenzi esiphatha ama-eksireyi</i>
physiotherapist	<i>isazi sesayensi yokusebenza kwezitho zomzimba</i>
visitor	<i>isivakashi</i>
student	<i>umfundi / isitshudeni</i>
teacher	<i>uthisha</i>

Take note! There are no Zulu words for the English articles “a(n)” and “the”. Whenever these articles appear in English sentences in front of nouns, they are never translated into Zulu – they will merely be ignored or deleted in the Zulu construction.

The following verbs may be found useful with parts of the body:

cabanga (think)

cimeza (close eyes)

hlafuna (chew)

finya (blow nostril)

khothama (bow, bend)

shefa (shave) ***phefumula***

(breathe) ***khamisa*** (open

mouth) ***cwayiza*** (blink)

gwinya (swallow)

khotha (lick)

xubha (rinse mouth)

guqa (kneel)

enyela (get sprained)

A FEW IMPORTANT EXPRESSIONS

Do you know Zulu?

Uyasazi isiZulu?

I know it a little. I am still learning it.

Ngisazi kancane. Ngisasifunda.

Sorry, I do not understand you.

Uxolo, angiqondi kahle. /Angikuzwisisi.

Please speak slowly.

Awukhulume kancane.

What do you mean?	<i>Usho ukuthini?</i>
What are you saying?	<i>Uthini?</i>
Please repeat.	<i>Awuphinde.</i>
Can I help you?	<i>Ngingakusiza na?</i>
How do you feel?	<i>Uzizwa unjani?</i>
I am not feeling well.	<i>Angiphili neze.</i>
I feel fine.	<i>Ngiphila kahle.</i>
I hope you get/feel better.	<i>Ngithemba ukuthi ululame.</i>
I have a headache.	<i>Ngiphethwe yikhanda.</i>
I have the flu.	<i>Ngiphethwe yi-flu.</i>
I feel dizzy.	<i>Ngiphethwe yinzululwane.</i>
I feel weak.	<i>Anginamandla.</i>
How long have you been ill?	<i>Sewugula isikhathi esingakanani?</i>
When did you start feeling sick?	<i>Uqale nini ukugula?</i>
Are you nauseous?	<i>Unesicanucanu na?</i>
I am nauseas.	<i>Nginesicanucanu.</i>
It hurts when I move.	<i>Kubuhlungu uma nginyakaza.</i>
How long have you been ill?	<i>Sewugula isikhathi esingakanani?</i>
When did you start feeling sick?	<i>Uqale nini ukugula?</i>
Sorry!	<i>Uxolo! / Ngiyaxolisa!</i>
Follow me.	<i>Ngilandele.</i>
What is the problem?	<i>Iyini inkinga?</i>
Do you have diarrhoea?	<i>Uphethwe yisihudo?</i>
Are you constipated?	<i>Uqumbile na?</i>
Do you have any chronic illnesses?	<i>Unokugulela kwafuthi?</i>
You will need an operation.	<i>Kuzodingeka ukuba uhlinzwe.</i>
Have you been operated on previously?	<i>Sewuhlinziwe ngaphambili?</i>
You must be tested.	<i>Kumele uhlolwe.</i>
Phone the ambulance.	<i>Fonela i-ambulense.</i>
Let us meet / Let us have a meeting.	<i>Masihlangane.</i>
We will see each other again.	<i>Sobonana futhi.</i>

'Long time no see!'	<i>Mehlomadala!</i>
Have a lovely day.	<i>Ube nosuku oluhle.</i>
Have a lovely night.	<i>Ube nobusuku obuhle.</i>
Sleep tight.	<i>Lala kamnandi / Lala kahle.</i>
Sweet dreams.	<i>Amaphupho amahle.</i>
Remember to smile!	<i>Khumbula ukumoyizela!</i>
I wish you all the best!	<i>Ngikufisela okuhle kodwa!</i>
You are very kind/friendly.	<i>Unomusa omkhulu.</i>
Congratulations!	<i>Halala!</i>
Cheers!	<i>Impilonhle!</i>
Happy Birthday!	<i>Usuku lokuzalwa oluhle!</i>
How old are you?	<i>Umdala kangakanani? /Uneminyaka emingaki?</i>

Type text here

ISIFUNDO 4: CONSTRUCTION OF SIMPLE SENTENCES

be ill	<i>gula</i>
love / like	<i>thanda</i>
buy	<i>thenga</i>
sell	<i>thengisa</i>
see	<i>bona</i>
request	<i>cela</i>
give	<i>nika</i>
pray	<i>thandaza</i>
borrow	<i>boleka</i>
pay	<i>khokha</i>
agree	<i>vuma</i>
smoke	<i>bhema</i>
look for / want	<i>funa</i>
need	<i>dinga</i>
touch	<i>thinta</i>
gossip	<i>hleba</i>
waste / spill	<i>chitha</i>
know	<i>azi</i>
carry	<i>thwala</i>
hit	<i>shaya</i>
find / receive	<i>thola</i>
argue	<i>phikisana</i>
quarrel	<i>xabana</i>
tell	<i>tshela</i>

Learn the following subjectival concords:

Full form	Positive subject concord	Meaning
<i>Mina</i>	<i>ngi-</i>	I
<i>Thina</i>	<i>si-</i>	we
<i>Wena</i>	<i>u-</i>	you
<i>Nina</i>	<i>ni-</i>	you (pl.)
<i>Bona</i>	<i>ba-</i>	they
<i>Yena</i>	<i>u-</i>	he/she

The concords of the first and second persons

The first person "I" in the singular and "we" in the plural; the second person singular and plural "you", are also expressed by means of subject concords. The concords for the third person singular and plural are the same as for classes 1 and 2, viz *u-* (he/she) and *ba-* (they). The subject concord for the second person singular and the third person singular appears to be the same viz *u-* ("you" and "he/she"). However, there is a difference in tone. The second person concord is always low, and the third person concord is always high.

SIMPLE SENTENCES IN THE PRESENT TENSE:

POSITIVE CONSTRUCTIONS

There are two constructions for composing simple positive present tense sentences.

Construction 1: No words follow after the action.

Compulsory concord + -ya- + verb (action) ending on -a

Examples:

<i>Yena uyapheka.</i>	She is cooking. 3rd person - singular
<i>Bona bayadlala.</i>	They are playing. 3rd person - plural
<i>Yena uyahleka.</i>	He\She is laughing. 3rd person - singular
<i>Thina siyagijima.</i>	We are running. 1st person - plural
<i>Nina niyacula.</i>	You (pl.) are singing. 2nd person - plural
<i>Ngiyaphumula.</i>	I am resting. 1st person - singular

ASKING QUESTIONS WITH CONSTRUCTION 1: NO WORDS FOLLOW AFTER THE ACTION.

Positive compulsory concord + ya + action NA?

Examples:

Does she cook?

She cooks huh?

Yena, u+ ya + pheka na?

=Yena uyapheka na?

Do they play?

They play huh?

Bona, ba + ya + dlala na?

=Bona, bayadlala na?

Is he/she laughing?

He/She is laughing huh?

Yena u + ya + hleka na?

=Yena, uyahleka na?

Do you (pl. sing)

You sing huh?

Nina, ni + ya + cula na?

=Nina, niyacula na?

CONSTRUCTION 2: WORDS FOLLOW AFTER THE ACTION.

Positive compulsory concord + action (verb) ending on -a followed by a noun/ adverb.

Examples:

I am teaching Zulu.	Ngi + fundisa isiZulu	=Ngifundisa isiZulu.
We listen to music.	Si + lalala umculo	= Silalala umculo.
They read a book.	Ba + funda incwadi	= Bafunda incwadi.
He / She answers quickly.	(Yena) u+ phendula masinyane= Yena uphendula masinyane.	

ASKING QUESTIONS WITH CONSTRUCTION 2: WORDS FOLLOW AFTER THE ACTION.

Positive compulsory concord + action (verb) followed by a noun/adverb NA?

Examples:

Do you teach Zulu?

You teach Zulu huh? **Wena u + fundisa isiZulu na?**

= Ufundisa isiZulu na?

Do they cook food?

They cook food huh? **Ba + pheka ukudla na?**

=Bapheka ukudla na?

NEGATIVE SENTENCES

Full form	Compulsory concord	Meaning
Mina	angi-	I
Thina	asi-	We
Wena	awu-	You
Nina	ani-	You (pl.)
Yena	aka-	He/She
Bona	aba-	They

NEGATIVE CONSTRUCTIONS

There is only one construction for composing simple negative present tense sentences.

Negative compulsory concord + action (ending on -i) noun/adverb if any.

Examples:

Yena akapheki.	She is not cooking.
Bona abadlali.	They are not playing.
Yena akahleki.	He\She is not laughing.
Thina asigijimi.	We are not running.
Nina, aniculi.	You (pl.) are not singing.
Angiphumuli.	I am not resting.
Awufundisi isiZulu na?	Do you not teach Zulu?

NOTE: The 2 key time words for the present tense are:

today ***namhlanje / namuhla***

now ***manje***

UMSEBENZI WASEKHAYA (Homework 2) - Simple sentences in the Present tense

Translate these positive and negative present tense sentences into Zulu.

	POSITIVE	NEGATIVE
They are working.	Bayasebenza	Abayasebenz
He is taking an x-ray (i-eksireyi).	Itaatha i-eksiryei	Akathathi i-eksiryei
She is resting.	Uyaphemola	Akaphemoli
Are you (pl.) helping?	Uyasiza na?	Awuszi na?i
I am going.	ngiyaya	angiyi
Do you remember?	uyakhumbula na ?	awukhumbuli na?

HOW TO GIVE AND TAKE

If one hands something to a Zulu, the right hand must be used, even though you may be left-handed. It is not good manners to use your left hand. To indicate to the person to whom you are giving something that you hold him in respect, you must hold your right arm's wrist with your left hand.

The same custom applies when something is received. You will see that Zulus cup their hands when accepting something. This has nothing to do with begging - it is simply good manners.

GRATITUDE

Sometimes it may appear that a Zulu person is ungrateful for gifts received or favours done. There may be varying reasons for this. One is that gratitude may be expressed gesturally rather than verbally. For example, a slight curtsey may be made or the hands may be clapped together as a sign of appreciation which may, however, go by unnoticed by the unfamiliar. Alternatively, the person may be too overcome to express thanks directly, especially if the giver is a superior. If someone else is available, he will ask that person to express gratitude on his behalf; if not, the thanks may well go unuttered.

When receiving something in the Zulu culture, you can say 'THANK YOU' by:

- ✓ using the word NGIYABONGA
- ✓ using an action only that means the same as 'THANK YOU'; or
- ✓ using the word NGIYABONGA together with an action

ISIFUNDO 5: SIMPLE SENTENCES IN THE FUTURE TENSE

Learn the following vocabulary-Zulu nouns and actions.

a person	<i>umuntu</i>
man	<i>indoda</i>
woman	<i>umfazi</i>
child	<i>umntwana / ingane</i>
boy	<i>umfana</i>
girl	<i>intombi</i>
baby	<i>ingane</i>
parents	<i>abazali</i>
letter	<i>incwadi</i>
scissors	<i>isikele</i>
blanket	<i>ingubo</i>
pillow	<i>iphilo / umcamelo</i>
gift	<i>isipho</i>
bandage	<i>ibhandishi</i>
x-ray	<i>i-eksireyi</i>
sling	<i>isilengiso</i>
blood pressure	<i>umfutho wegazi</i>
heart beat	<i>ukushaya kwenhliziyo</i>
temperature	<i>izinga lokushisa</i>
accident	<i>ingozi</i>
a file	<i>ifayili</i>
scale	<i>isikali</i>
syringe	<i>isipotsho</i>
injection	<i>umjovo</i>
pills	<i>amaphilisi</i>
stethoscope	<i>izipopolo zikadokotela</i>
wheelchair	<i>isitulo sokuhamba</i>
crutch	<i>induku yenxuge</i>
splint	<i>imbande</i>
picture	<i>isithombe</i>
plaster	<i>iplasta</i>
wound	<i>isilonda</i>
job / work	<i>umsebenzi</i>
injury	<i>ukulimala</i>
operation	<i>ukuhlinzwa</i>
thing / an object	<i>into</i>

glasses	<i>izibuko</i>
cigarette	<i>usikilidi</i>
test	<i>isivivinyo</i>
ointment	<i>umbheco</i>
soap	<i>insipho</i>
help	<i>usizo</i>
do	<i>enza</i>
shout	<i>memeza</i>
make a noise	<i>banga umsindo</i>
kick	<i>khahlela</i>
chat	<i>xoxa</i>
choose	<i>khetha</i>
wait for	<i>lindela</i>
arrive	<i>fika</i>
kill	<i>bulala</i>
shoot	<i>dubula</i>
laugh	<i>hleka</i>
smile	<i>moyizela</i>
visit	<i>vakashela</i>
complain	<i>khala/khononda/bubula</i>
greet	<i>bingelela</i>
hurt / injure	<i>limaza</i>
lie	<i>khuluma amanga</i>

POSITIVE CONSTRUCTIONS

There is only **one construction** for composing **simple positive future tense sentences**.

One Positive construction only

NGI

SI

(WENA) U + ZO + ACTION (ENDS ON -A)

NI

(YENA) U

BA

To indicate an action which will take place in the future, -zo- is inserted between the subjectival concord and the verb stem, e.g.:

- We will work.

Si + zo + sebenza

Sizosebenza.

- He/She will write.

Yena u + zo + bhala

Yena, uzobhala.

- You (pl) will sing.

Ni + zo + cula

Nizocula.

Asking questions with this construction:

positive subject concords + ZO + ACTION NA?

- Will you study? You will study huh?

Wena, u + zo + funda na?

Wena uzofunda na?

- Will they leave today? They will leave today huh?

Ba + zo + hamba namuhla na?

Bazohamba na?

- Will you(pl) help? You(pl) will help huh?

Ni + zo + siza na?

Nizosiza na?

NEGATIVE CONSTRUCTIONS

There is only **one construction** for composing **simple negative future tense sentences**.

- ✓ In the negative -zo- gives place to **-zu-**
- ✓ The last vowel of the verb does not change to -I in the negative

ANGI

ASI

AWU + ZU + ACTION (ENDS ON -A)

ANI

AKA

ABA

Examples:

- We will not work.

Asi + zu + sebenza

Asizusebenza.

- He/She will not write.

Yena aka + zu + bhala

Akazubhala.

- You(pl) will not sing.

ani + zu + cula

Anizucula.

- Will you not study? You will not study huh?

Wena, awu + zu + funda na?

Wena, awuzufunda na?

- Will you(pl) not help? You (pl) will not help huh?

Ani + zu + siza na?

Anizusiza na?

NOTE: The key time word for the future tense is:

tomorrow → ***kusasa***

UMSEBENZI WASEKHAYA (Homework 3)- Simple sentences in the Future tense

Translate these positive and negative future tense sentences into Zulu.

	POSITIVE	NEGATIVE
They will donate blood (<i>nikeza igazi</i>).		
She will take an x-ray.		
Will you sleep?		
I will rest.		
Will you come back?		

ISIFUNDO 6: SIMPLE SENTENCES IN THE PAST TENSE

POSITIVE CONSTRUCTIONS

There are **two constructions** for composing **simple positive past tense sentences**.

Construction 1: No words follow after the action.

NGI

SI

(WENA) U + ACTION (ENDS ON -ILE)

NI

(YENA) U

BA

Examples:

He studied.

Yena, u + fund + ile (-funda)

Yena, ufundile.

They left.

Ba + hamb + ile (-hambile)

Bahambile.

She drank.

Yena, u + phuz + ile (-phuzile)

Yena, uphuzile.

Asking questions with construction 1: No words follow after the action.

positive concords ACTION ending on -ILE NA?

Examples:

Did she speak?

(-khuluma)

She spoke huh?

Ukhulumile na?

Did you call?

(-biza)

You called huh?

Ubizile na?

Did they leave?

(-hamba)

They left huh?

Bahambile na?

Construction 2: Words follow after the action.

NGI

SI

(WENA) U + ACTION (ENDS ON -E) NOUN /ADVERB

NI

(YENA) U

BA

Examples:

They have cleaned the wound.

Bageze isilonda. / Bahlanze isilonda. *(-geza / -hlanza)*

She cooked the food.

Yena, upheke ukudla. *(-pheka)*

He studied Zulu.

Ufunde isiZulu.

(-funda)

Asking questions with construction 2: Words follow after the action.

positive concords ACTION ending on –E NOUN / ADVERB NA?

Examples:

Did he buy shoes?

(-thenga)

He bought shoes huh?

Yena uthenge izicathulo na?

Did they write the test?

(-bhala)

They wrote the test huh?

Bona babhale isivivinyo na?

Did you spill water?

(-chitha)

You spilled water huh?

Nichithe amanzi na?

Negative constructions

There is only **one construction** for composing **simple negative past tense sentences**.

One negative construction for both positive constructions above

ANGI

ASI

AWU

ANI + ACTION (ENDS ON –ANGA) [NOUN / ADVERB] (IF ANY)

AKA

ABA

Examples:

They did not clean the sore. *(-geza/ -hlanza)*

Abagezanga isilonda. / Abahlanzanga isilonda.

She did not speak. *(-khuluma)*

Yena, akakhulumanga.

Did you(pl) not spill water? *(-chitha)*

You(pl) did not spill water huh?

Anichithanga amanzi na?

Did they not write the test? *(-bhala)*

They did not write the test huh?

Ababhalanga isivivinyo na?

NOTE: The key time word for the past tense is:

yesterday → *izolo*

UMSEBENZI WASEKHAYA (Homework 4) Simple sentences in the past tense

Translate these positive and negative past tense sentences into Zulu.

	POSITIVE	NEGATIVE
They arrived.		
We took an x-ray.		
I washed the hands.		
He ate a banana.		
They donated blood.		
Did you sleep?		

ISIFUNDO 7: SIMPLE SENTENCES IN THE STATIVE TENSE

Stative verbs are words which express a state which started a while ago and which is still continuing. Stative verbs express emotional or physical states of being.

The Zulu verb which expresses this state will have the form of a verb in the past tense, but the verb does not express an action which has been completed.

POSITIVE CONSTRUCTIONS

There is only one construction for composing simple positive stative tense sentences in Zulu.

One Positive construction only

LEARN THE FOLLOWING VOCABULARY – ZULU STATIVE VERBS

hungry	<i>lambile</i>
thirsty	<i>omile</i>
deceased	<i>shonile</i>
dead	<i>file</i>
tired	<i>diniwe / khathele</i>
injured	<i>limele</i>
sure	<i>qinisile</i>
worried	<i>khathazekile / hluphekile</i>
angry	<i>thukuthele</i>
asleep	<i>lele</i>
seated	<i>hleli / hlezi</i>
be fine / okay	<i>lungile</i>
be well (in health)	<i>philile</i>
disabled	<i>khubazekile</i>
satisfied	<i>anelisiwe</i>
busy	<i>bambekile</i>
important	<i>balulekile</i>
sad	<i>dabukile</i>
happy	<i>jabulile</i>
clean	<i>hlanzekile</i>

dirty	<i>ngcolile</i>
expensive	<i>dulile</i>
cheap	<i>shibhile</i>
drunk	<i>dakiwe</i>
married	<i>shadiwe / shadile</i>
pregnant	<i>khulelwe</i>
broken	<i>ephukile</i>
finished (come to an end)	<i>phelile</i>
finished (doing something)	<i>qedile</i>
have (on you)	<i>phethe</i>
disappointed	<i>danile / dumele</i>
understand each other	<i>zwene</i>
confused	<i>xakekile</i>

POSITIVE CONSTRUCTIONS

NGI

SI

(WENA) U + STATIVE VERB

NI

(YENA) U

BA

KU

Examples:

- I am tired (-khathele/ diniwe)
= *Ng*i + *khathele* → ***Ngikhathele***.
- We are hungry (-lambile)
= *Si* + *lambile* → ***Silambile***.
- They are drunk (-dakiwe)
= *Ba* + *dakiwe* → ***Badakiwe***.
- It is fine / okay (-lungile)

= *Ku + lungile* → ***Kulungile***.

NEGATIVE CONSTRUCTIONS

There is only one construction for composing simple negative stative tense sentences.

One negative construction

ANGI

ASI

AWU

ANI + STATIVE VERB (UNCHANGED)

AKA

ABA

AKU

Examples:

- I am not worried (-khathazekile)
= *Angi + khathazekile* → ***Angikhathazekile***.
- They are not angry (-thukuthele)
= *Aba + thukuthele* → ***Abathukuthele***.
- She is not asleep (-lele)
= *Aka + lele* → ***Akalele***.
- It is not fine. (-lungile)
= *Aku + lungile* → ***Akulungile***.

UMSEBENZI WASEKHAYA (Homework 5) -The stative tense

Translate these positive and negative stative tense sentences into Zulu.

	POSITIVE	NEGATIVE
They are confused.		
It is dirty.		
She is pregnant.		
We are worried.		
Are you (pl) married?		
He is angry.		

ISIFUNDO 8: THE ZULU PREPOSITION NA-

THE USE OF NA-

- In isiZulu, vowels are never found following one another in the same word.
- Sometimes words or parts of words have to be joined together, and in so doing two vowels may be juxtaposed. Then one of three things happens:

- I. One of the vowels may be dropped or elided.
- II. *y* or *w* (or occasionally *s* or *k*) may be inserted to keep the vowels apart)
- III. The vowels may merge or fuse and give rise to a new vowel. The merging of vowels is called coalescence.

a+a* = *a

a+i* = *e

a+u* = *o

- *Na-* never stands by itself.
- Prefixing *na-* to any noun except class 2a, will result in juxtaposition, and usually merging of vowels.
- In negative constructions with *na-* there is no coalescence.
- This little word also expresses FOUR different meanings (actually 3 meanings – because one of these meanings is just the negative version of its positive counterpart).

These meanings are:

- HAS / HAVE (A NOUN)
- DOESN'T / DON'T HAVE (A NOUN)
- AND (A NOUN)
- (TOGETHER) WITH (SOMEONE)

1. *NA* with the meaning of HAS / HAVE

- The English word 'have' is expressed in Zulu by using *na-*.
- *Na-* comes in between the subjectival concord of the governing noun and the noun or pronoun indicating is 'had'.
- In the positive forms vowel coalescence takes place when *na-* is prefixed to nouns.

CONSTRUCTION:

NGI

SI

(WENA) U

NI

(YENA) U + NA- + NOUN

BA

Examples:

- I have a child. (umntwana)

= *Ngi + na + umntwana.*

→ ***Nginomntwana.***

- We have a dog. (inja)

= *Si + na + inja*

→ ***Sinenja.***

- She has books. (amabhuku)

= *(Yena) u + na + amabhuku.*

→ ***(Yena) unamabhuku.***

Turning these constructions into questions:

Positive subject concords + NA + NOUN NA?

Remember to apply the sound changes after NA!

A few examples:

- You have pain huh? (ubuhlungu)

= (Wena) u + na + ubuhlungu na?

→ (Wena) unobuhlungu na?

- You have a cold huh? (umkhuhlane)

= (Wena) u + na + umkhuhlane na?

→ (Wena) unomkhuhlane na?

- You have questions huh? (imibuzo)

= (Wena) u + na + imibuzo na?

→ (Wena) unemibuzo na?

Learn the following phrase:

What is the matter with you?

Unani?

2. NA with the meaning of DOES / DO NOT HAVE

- NO sound changes will take place in negative constructions containing NA.
- NA will always be used.

CONSTRUCTION:

ANGI

ASI

(WENA) AWU + NA + NOUN

ANI

(YENA) AKA

ABA

Examples:

- I don't have time. (isikhathi)

= *Angi + na + isikhathi.*

→ ***Anginasikhathi.***

- He doesn't have knowledge. (ulwazi)

= *(Yena) Aka + na + ulwazi.*

→ ***(Yena) Akanalwazi.***

- Don't you have medicine? ("You don't have medicine huh?") (umuthi)

= *(Wena) Awu + na + umuthi na?*

→ ***Wena awunamuthi na?***

3. NA with the meaning of AND / ALSO

? Question phrase applicable here.

and what else? = ***nani futhi?*** [placed at the end of the sentence]

Examples:

The person sees James and Sipho

Umuntu ubona uJames na- + uSipho.

Umuntu ubona uJames noSipho.

I love father and mother.

Ngithanda ubaba na- + umama

Ngithanda ubaba nomama.

- You speak Zulu and what else?

→ *(Wena) ukhuluma isiZulu nani futhi?*

- You ate bread and what else?

→ *(Wena) udle isinkwa **nani futhi?***

- You injured the back and what else?

→ *(Wena) ulimaze umhlane **nani futhi?***

! Answer construction applicable here.

___ and (also) NOUN = ___ NA + NOUN

A few examples

- I speak Zulu and English (isiNgisi) and Afrikaans (isiBhunu).

→ *Ngikhuluma isiZulu nesiNgisi nesiBhunu.*

- You injured the back and the arm (ingalo) and the leg (umlenze).

→ *(Wena) ulimaze umhlane nengalo nomlenze.*

- Use water and soap (insipho)!

→ *Sebenzisa amanzi nensipho!*

4. NA with the meaning of WITH (SOMEONE)

? Question phrase applicable here.

with whom? = ***nobani?*** [placed at the end of the sentence]

- You live with whom?

→ *(Wena) uhlala **nobani?***

- You spoke to (with) whom?

→ *(Wena) ukhulume **nobani?***

- You arrived with whom?

→ (Wena) ufike **nobani?**

! Answer construction applicable here.

___ with NOUN = ___ NA + NOUN

A few examples:

- Wait here with the patients (iziguli).

→ **Linda lapha neziguli.**

- Did you speak to (with) the doctor (udokotela)?

→ **(Wena) ukhulume nodokotela na?**

I will work with the children (abantwana).

→ **Ngizosebenza nabantwana.**

UMSEBENZI WASEKHAYA (Homework 6) The preposition NA-

1. Ask the following questions in Zulu and answer these questions in the negative.

Do you have a medical aid? _____.

Do you have medicine? _____.

Do they have pills? _____.

Do you have water? _____.

Do you have pain? _____.

Do they have food? _____.

Do you (pl.) have a problem? _____.

Do you have a fever? _____.

Do you have a question? _____.

Are you nauseous? _____.

**2. Ask the following questions in Zulu by making use of NANI FUTHI?
Also provide Zulu answers to these questions.**

You drink wine (*iwayini*) and what else?

_____.

=I drink wine and water.

_____ *biya* _____.

You like oranges (*amawolintshi*) and what else?

_____.

=I like oranges and apples.

_____.

He is taking off (*-khumula*) the shoes (*izicathulo*) and what else?

_____.

=He is taking off the shoes and socks.

_____.

We will buy plasters (*amaplasta*) and what else?

_____.

=We will buy plasters and bandages.

_____.

3. Ask the following questions in Zulu by making use of NOBANI?

1. Whom are you going (**-ya**) with?
_____?
2. Whom are you arguing (**-phikisana**) with?
_____?
3. Whom did they arrive (**-fika**) with?
_____?
4. Whom do you study (**-funda**) with?
_____?
5. Whom will you wait (**-linda**) with?
_____?

ISIFUNDO 9: THE ZULU PREPOSITION NGA-

The word NGA- also expresses THREE different meanings.

These meanings are:

- WITH (SOMETHING)
- ABOUT (A NOUN)
- ON / AT (A CERTAIN TIME)

1. NGA with the meaning of WITH / BY MEANS OF (SOMETHING)

? Question phrase applicable here.

with what? / How? = ngani? / kanjani? [placed at the end of the sentence]

A few examples

- ✓ You cleaned the wound with what?

(Wena) uhlanze isilonda ngani?

- ✓ You will examine the patient how?

(Wena) uzohlola isiguli kanjani?

! Answer construction applicable here.

___ with NOUN = ___ NGA + NOUN

- Learn the following SOUND CHANGES that will take place throughout in this lesson, and apply them in the constructions discussed here:

Sound changes.

a + i = e

a + u = o

a + a = a

A few examples

- ✓ He cleaned the wound with water (nga + amanzi) only.

= ***(Yena) uhlanze isilonda ngamanzi kuphela.***

- ✓ I will work with a machine (nga + umshini).

= ***Ngizosebenza ngomshini.***

- ✓ We will weigh you with the scale (nga + isikali).

= ***Sizokukala ngesikali.***

FORMS OF TRAVELLING/TRANSPORT

Notice the use of **NGA-** followed by nouns and the sound changes which take place when they are glued together.

I travel by means of the bus ***ibhasi***

Ngihamba ngebhasi.

I travel by means of a taxi ***ithekisi***

Ngihamba ngethekisi.

I travel by means of a bicycle ***ibhayisikili***

Ngihamba ngebhayisikili.

I travel by means of a motorbike ***isithuthuthu***

Ngihamba ngesithuthuthu.

I travel by means of the feet (i.e. I walk) ***izinyawo***

Ngihamba ngezinyawo.

I travel by means of an airplane ***ibhanoyi/ indiza.***

Ngihamba ngebhanoyi/ ngendiza.

I travel by means of the train *isitimela*
Ngihamba ngesitimela.

I travel by means of a car *imoto*
Ngihamba ngemoto.

2. NGA with the meaning of ABOUT

! Construction of statements applicable here

___ about NOUN = ___ NGA + NOUN

A few examples

✓ She is complaining about the patient (nga + isiguli).
= ***(Yena) ukhala ngesiguli.***

✓ Tell me about the accident (nga + ingozi)
= ***Ngitshela ngengozi.***

✓ I am worried about the injury (nga + ukulimala)
= ***Ngikhathazekile ngokulimala.***

3. NGA with the meaning of ON / AT A CERTAIN TIME

? Question phrase applicable here.

when? = *nini?* [placed at the end of the sentence]

A few examples

✓ They arrived when? = ***Bafike nini?***
✓ You will return when? = ***(Wena) uzobuya nini?***

! Answer construction applicable here.

We will be answering these questions by replacing the **question word** with **words indicating time**.

VOCABULARY – TIME WORDS – ISIKHATHI

in the morning	<i>ekuseni</i>
at noon	<i>emini</i>
in the afternoon	<i>ntambama</i>
in the evening	<i>kusihlwa</i>
at night	<i>ebusuku</i>
this week	<i>ngaleli viki</i>
next week	<i>ngeviki elizayo</i>
last week	<i>ngeviki eledlule</i>
day before yesterday	<i>kuthangi</i>
yesterday	<i>izolo</i>
today	<i>namhlanje / namuhla</i>
tomorrow	<i>kusasa</i>
day after tomorrow	<i>ngomhlomunye</i>
now	<i>manje</i>
soon	<i>maduze</i>
over the weekend	<i>ngempelasonto</i>

VOCABULARY – DAYS OF THE WEEK – IZINSUKU ZEVIKI

Nga- indicating time.

on Monday	<i>ngoMvulo / ngoMsombuluko</i>
on Tuesday	<i>ngoLwesibili</i>
on Wednesday	<i>ngoLwesithathu</i>
on Thursday	<i>ngoLwesine</i>
on Friday	<i>ngoLwesihlanu</i>

on Saturday *ngoMgqibelo*
on Sunday *ngeSonto*

A few examples

✓ Please come back next week Monday.

= *Awubuye ngeviki elizayo ngoMvulo.*

✓ We will see each other tomorrow morning.

= *Sizobonana kusasa ekuseni.*

Additional question phrases related to time:

at which time? = *ngasiphi isikhathi?* at the end of the sentence

on which day? = *ngaluphi usuku?* at the end of the sentence

Also learn the following phrase:

What is the time? = *Yisikhathi bani?*

A few examples

✓ You will arrive at which time?

= *(Wena) uzofika ngasiphi isikhathi?*

✓ You will return on which day?

= *(Wena) uzobuya ngaluphi usuku?*

A few examples

✓ I will return at eight o'clock.

= *Ngizobuya ngo-8 o'clock.*

✓ We will see each other tomorrow morning at half past nine.

= *Sizobonana kusasa ekuseni ngo-9:30.*

UMSEBENZI WASEKHAYA (Homework 7) The preposition NGA-

Provide the translations of these sentences:

1. We work with a big machine.

Sisebenza _____ omkhulu.

2. Fill the kettle with water.

Gcwalisa igedlela _____.

3. He is asking about the doctor.

Yena ubuza _____.

4. I will transport the patient with a wheelchair.

Ngizothutha isiguli _____.

5. They are talking about the girls.

Baxoxa _____.

6. We will rest over the weekend.

Sizophumula _____.

Ask the following questions in Zulu by making use of ngani? / Kanjani?

1. What are you (pl.) going (-ya) with?

_____.

2. How will you remove (-susa) the bandage?

_____.

3. What did they hit (-shaya) the child with?

_____.

4.How do you know (-azi)?

_____.

ISIFUNDO 10: THREE IMPORTANT ZULU CONSTRUCTIONS CONTAINING UKU-

POSITIVE SENTENCES

1. WANT TO which in Zulu is translated as *-FUNA UKU-*

CONSTRUCTION

Positive compulsory concord + *-FUNA UKU-* + ACTION (ends on -A)

A few examples

- I want to rest a little bit.

→ *Ngifuna ukuphumula kancane.*

- I want to go home now.

→ *Ngifuna ukuya ekhaya manje.*

- Do you want to see the doctor?

= You want to see the doctor huh?

→ *(Wena) ufuna ukubona udokotela na?*

2. LIKE TO which in Zulu is translated as *-THANDA UKU-*

CONSTRUCTION

Positive compulsory concord + -*THANDA UKU*- + ACTION
(ends on -A)

A few examples

- I like to work over the weekend.

→ *Ngithanda ukusebenza ngempelasonto.*

- I like to ask questions.

→ *Ngithanda ukubuza imibuzo.*

- We like to speak Zulu.

→ *Sithanda ukukhuluma isiZulu.*

3. CAN ('KNOW HOW TO') which in Zulu is translated as -*YAKWAZI UKU*-

CONSTRUCTION

Positive subject concord + -*YAKWAZI UKU*- + ACTION (ends on -A)

A few examples

- I can help you.

→ *Ngiyakwazi ukukusiza.*

- We can apply first aid.

→ *Siyakwazi ukunikeza usizo lokuqala.*

- Can you speak Zulu?

= You know how to speak Zulu huh?

→ *(Wena) uyakwazi ukukhuluma isiZulu na?*

NEGATIVE SENTENCES

4. DO NOT WANT TO which in Zulu is translated as -FUNI UKU-

CONSTRUCTION:

Negative compulsory concord + -FUNI UKU- + ACTION (ends on -A)

A few examples

- I don't want to answer.

→ *Angifuni ukuphendula.*

- I don't want to try again.

→ *Angifuni ukuzama futhi.*

- We don't want to bother you.

→ *Asifuni ukukuphazamisa.*

5. DO NOT LIKE TO which in Zulu is translated as -THANDI UKU-

CONSTRUCTION

Negative compulsory concord + -THANDI UKU- + ACTION
(ends on -A)

A few examples

- I do not like to waste time.

→ *Angithandi ukuchitha isikhathi.*

- I do not like to lie.

→ *Angithandi ukukhuluma amanga.*

- We do not like to go there.

→ *Asithandi ukuya lapho.*

6. CAN NOT ('DON'T KNOW HOW TO') which in Zulu is translated as **-KWAZI UKU-**

CONSTRUCTION

Negative compulsory concord + **-KWAZI UKU-** + ACTION (ends on -A)

A few examples

- I cannot hear.

→ *Angikwazi ukuzwa.*

- I cannot continue.

→ *Angikwazi ukuqhubeka.*

- He cannot treat the pain.

→ *Akakwazi ukwelapha ubuhlungu.*

LEARN THESE HANDY PHRASES IN WHICH KU- APPEAR

How is it?	<i>Kunjani?</i>
It is good / nice.	<i>Kuhle.</i>
It is good (tastes nice)	<i>Kumnandi.</i>
It is bad / ugly.	<i>Kubi.</i>
It is okay.	<i>Kulungile.</i>
It will be all right.	<i>Kuzolunga.</i>
It is like that.	<i>Kunjalo.</i>
My pleasure.	<i>Kubonga mina.</i>
It is cold.	<i>Kuyabanda / Kumakhaza.</i>

It is hot.

Kuyashisa.

THE CONCEPT REQUESTING SOMETHING (A NOUN)

Positive compulsory concord + CELA NOUN

A few examples

- I am requesting water please.

→ *Ngicela amanzi.*

- We are requesting help please.

→ *Sicela usizo.*

UMSEBENZI WASEKHAYA (Homework 8) Three important Zulu constructions containing UKU-

Translate the following sentences and questions into Zulu.

1. I want to donate (*-nikeza*) blood (*igazi*).

2. I want to try to speak Zulu.

3. We want to finish the work (*umsebenzi*).

4. I like to eat porridge (*iphalishi*) in the morning.

5. Do you like to drink coffee?

6. Can you use a computer (*ikhompyutha*)?

7. I can translate (*-humusha*).

8. They don't want to wait.

9. He doesn't want to take x-rays.

10. I don't want to go in / enter.

11. I don't like to work over the weekend.

12. They don't like to drink wine (*iwayini*).

13. I cannot remember.

14. He cannot swim (*-bhukuda*).

ISIFUNDO 11: THE NOUN CLASSES OF ZULU – SINGULAR & PLURAL NOUNS

The noun classes.

- All the nouns in Zulu are divided into classes.
- Every noun class has its own unique prefix (and class number).
- Almost all noun classes are organized in pairs.
- One member of the pairs indicates the singular form of the noun, and the other member indicates the plural form of the noun.
- To change the singular form to the plural form, the singular prefix is deleted and replaced with the plural prefix. The same rule is applicable the other way around.

Examples of nouns in all the classes

1. um(u)-	singular	2. aba-	plural
umfundi	student	abafundi	
umfazi	woman	abafazi	
umntwana	child	abantwana	
umfana	boy	abafana	
umngane	friend	abangane	
umsizi	helper	abasizi	
umzali	parent	abazali	
umfundisi	preacher	abafundisi	
umuntu	person	abantu	
Exceptions			
umZulu	Zulu person	amaZulu	
umXhosa	Xhosa person	amaXhosa	
1a. u-	singular	2a. o-	plural

<i>udokotela</i>	doctor	<i>odokotela</i>	
<i>unesi</i>	nurse	<i>onesi</i>	
<i>uthisha</i>	teacher	<i>othisha</i>	
<i>ubaba</i>	father	<i>obaba</i>	
<i>umama</i>	mother	<i>omama</i>	
3. um(u)-	singular	4. imi-	plural
<i>umjovo</i>	injection	<i>imijovo</i>	vegetables
<i>umbhede</i>	bed	<i>imibhede</i>	
<i>umlomo</i>	mouth	<i>imilomo</i>	
<i>umphimbo</i>	throat	<i>imiphimbo</i>	
<i>umhlane</i>	back	<i>imihlane</i>	
<i>umunwe</i>	finger	<i>iminwe</i>	
<i>umlenze</i>	leg	<i>imilenze</i>	
<i>umsipha</i>	muscle	<i>imisipha</i>	
-	-	<i>imifino</i>	
<i>umuthi</i>	medicine	<i>imithi</i>	
<i>umsebenzi</i>	work / job	<i>imisebenzi</i>	
<i>umkhuhlane</i>	a cold	<i>imikhuhlane</i>	
<i>umbuzo</i>	question	<i>imibuzo</i>	
<i>umshini</i>	machine	<i>imishini</i>	
<i>umzimba</i>	body	<i>imizimba</i>	
5. i(li)-	singular	6. ama-	plural
<i>iphilisi</i>	pill / tablet	<i>amaphilisi</i>	
<i>ikhanda</i>	head	<i>amakhanda</i>	
<i>iso</i>	eye	<i>amehlo</i>	
<i>iphimbo</i>	voice	<i>amaphimbo</i>	
<i>ikhala</i>	nose	<i>amakhala</i>	
<i>ihlombe</i>	shoulder	<i>amahlombe</i>	
<i>idolo</i>	knee	<i>amadolo</i>	
<i>iphaphu</i>	lung	<i>amaphaphu</i>	

<i>igazi</i>	blood	-	
<i>i-eksireyi</i>	x-ray	<i>ama-eksireyi</i>	
<i>ipeni</i>	pen	<i>amapeni</i>	
<i>ibhuku</i>	book	<i>amabhuku</i>	
<i>iphepha</i>	paper	<i>amaphepha</i>	
<i>itafula</i>	table	<i>amatafula</i>	
<i>ihembe</i>	shirt	<i>amahembe</i>	
<i>ibhulukwe</i>	trousers	<i>amabhulukwe</i>	
<i>ilokwe</i>	dress	<i>amalokwe</i>	
<i>ijezi</i>	jersey	<i>amajezi</i>	
<i>ikhompyutha</i>	computer	<i>amakhompyutha</i>	
<i>ikhofi</i>	coffee	-	
<i>itiye</i>	tea	-	
<i>ibhisikidi</i>	biscuit	<i>amabhisikidi</i>	
<i>isaladi</i>	salad	<i>amasaladi</i>	
<i>ihhovisi</i>	office	<i>amahhovisi</i>	
<i>ikilini</i>	clinic	<i>amakilini</i>	
<i>iplasta</i>	plaster	<i>amaplasta</i>	
<i>ithemometha</i>	thermometer	<i>amathemometha</i>	
<i>iwashi</i>	watch	<i>amawashi</i>	
<i>ibhandishi</i>	bandage	<i>amabhandishi</i>	
<i>ikamelo</i>	room	<i>amakamelo</i>	
<i>iphalishi</i>	porridge	<i>amaphalishi</i>	
<i>igama</i>	name	<i>amagama</i>	
<i>ibhodlela</i>	bottle	<i>amabhodlela</i>	
<i>igawuni</i>	gown	<i>amagawuni</i>	
<i>iphutha</i>	mistake	<i>amaphutha</i>	
<i>izinyo</i>	tooth	<i>amazinyo</i>	
-	-	<i>amanzi</i>	water
-	-	<i>amandla</i>	power

7. isi-	singular	8. izi-	plural
isikele	scissors	izikele	mirrors / glasses
isinqe	buttock	izinqe	
isifuba	chest	izifuba	
isisu	stomach	izisu	
isandla	hand	izandla	
isihlakala	wrist	izihlakala	
isikhumba	skin	izikhumba	
isithelo	fruit	izithelo	
isinkwa	bread	izinkwa	
isilonda	wound	izilonda	
isiguli	patient	iziguli	
isivakashi	visitor	izivakashi	
isihlalo	chair	izihlalo	
isikhiye	key	izikhiye	
isicathulo	shoe	izicathulo	
isikhiba	t-shirt	izikhiba	
isazi	expert	izazi	
isitshudeni	student	izitshudeni	
isikhathi	time	izikhathi	
isibhedlela	hospital	izibhedlela	
isibuko	mirror	izibuko	
isikali	scale	izikali	
isiZulu	Zulu language	-	
isiNgisi	English	-	
isiBhunu	Afrikaans	-	
isibongo	surname	izibongo	
isithombe	picture	izithombe	
isikhwama	bag	izikhwama	
isifo	illness	izifo	

-	-	<i>izipopolo</i> <i>zikadokotela</i>	stethoscope
9. in-/im-	singular	10. izin-/izim-	plural
<i>intamo</i>	neck	<i>izintamo</i>	
<i>indlebe</i>	ear	<i>izindlebe</i>	
<i>ingalo</i>	arm	<i>izingalo</i>	
<i>indololwane</i>	elbow	<i>izindololwane</i>	
<i>inhliziyo</i>	heart	<i>izinhliziyo</i>	
<i>inyama</i>	meat	-	
<i>intombi</i>	girl	<i>izintombi</i>	
<i>ingane</i>	child	<i>izingane</i>	
<i>impensele</i>	pencil	<i>izimpensele</i>	
<i>incwadi</i>	letter / book	<i>izincwadi</i>	
<i>imali</i>	money	-	
<i>ingubo</i>	blanket / piece of clothing	<i>izingubo</i>	
<i>indaba</i>	news / story	<i>izindaba</i>	
<i>inkinga</i>	problem	<i>izinkinga</i>	
<i>imfiva</i>	fever	-	
<i>impendulo</i>	answer	<i>izimpendulo</i>	
<i>imoto</i>	car	<i>izimoto</i>	
<i>impilo</i>	health / life	-	
<i>ingozi</i>	danger	<i>izingozi</i>	
<i>into</i>	something / object	<i>izinto</i>	
<i>indlu</i>	house	<i>izindlu</i>	
<i>imbali</i>	flower	<i>izimbali</i>	
Exceptions			
<i>inkosazana</i>	unmarried woman married woman	<i>amakhosazana</i>	

<i>inkosikazi</i> <i>indoda</i> <i>intombazana</i>	man girl	<i>amakhosikazi</i> <i>amadoda</i> <i>amantombazana</i>	
11. u(lu)-	singular	10. izin-	plural
<i>ulimi</i> <i>unyawo</i> <i>ubisi</i> <i>usizo</i> <i>(unwele)</i> <i>usuku</i> <i>ulwazi</i> <i>uthando</i>	tongue / language foot milk help hair day knowledge love	<i>izilimi</i> <i>izinyawo</i> - - <i>izinwele</i> <i>izinsuku</i> - -	
14. ubu-	singular only		
<i>ubuso</i> <i>ubuchopho</i> <i>ubuhlungu</i> <i>ubuntu</i> <i>ubungane</i>	face brain pain humanity friendship		
15. uku-			
<i>ukudla</i> <i>ukushisa</i> <i>ukufa</i>	food heat death		

TABLE OF THE ZULU NOUN CLASSES

PAIR 1	class 1	um(u)-	singular nouns
	class 2	aba-	plural nouns
PAIR 2	class 1a.	u-	singular nouns

	class 2a.	<i>o-</i>	plural nouns
PAIR 3	class 3	<i>um(u)-</i>	singular nouns
	class 4	<i>imi-</i>	plural nouns
PAIR 4	class 5	<i>i(li)-</i>	singular nouns
	class 6	<i>ama-</i>	plural nouns
PAIR 5	class 7	<i>isi-</i>	singular nouns
	class 8	<i>izi-</i>	plural nouns
PAIR 6	class 9	<i>in-/ im-</i>	singular nouns
	class 10	<i>izin-/ izim-</i>	plural nouns
PART OF PAIR 7	class 11	<i>u(lu)-</i>	singular nouns
	class 14	<i>ubu-</i>	singular nouns
	class 15	<i>uku-</i>	both nouns and verbs

A few explanatory notes on the contents of the classes

Classes 1 and 2

- Words that refer to human beings.
- Not all nouns referring to human beings appear in these classes.

- Nouns referring to humans are also found in some of the other classes.
- Most nouns start with the prefix *um-*, only a few nouns contain the full prefix *umu-*. Both prefixes will be replaced by the prefix *aba-* to form the plural forms.

Classes 1a and 2a

- All names and surnames of people belong to these two classes
- Some nouns referring to human beings such as family members.

Classes 3 and 4

- All *umu-* / *um-* objects / things
- There are only a few nouns containing the full prefix *umu-* (just like classes 1 and 2).
- Replaced by *imi-* to form the plural forms.

Classes 5 and 6

- Borrowed words from other languages.
- The shortened form *i-* of the full prefix *ili-* is used for singular nouns.

Classes 7 and 8 Classes 9 and 10

- All these classes contain miscellaneous words. Names of languages are found in class 7 (*isi-* class).
- A lot of nouns referring to animals and borrowed words appear in classes 9 and 10.

Classes 11 and 10

- Plurals of nouns in class 11 are formed by making use of the prefix of class 10 (*izin-* / *izim-*).
- The shortened form *u-* of the full form of the prefix *ulu-* is used for singular nouns.

Class 14

- Mostly abstract nouns and do not have plural forms.

Class 15

- The prefix of class 15 *uku-* has the meaning of 'TO'
- These words are not classified as either singular or plural nouns.
- Words in this class can appear as nouns or verbs.

UMSEBENZI WASEKHAYA (Homework 9) The noun classes of Zulu – Singular & Plural Nouns

Provide the correct singular and plural Zulu forms of the nouns below.

<i>abantwana</i>		<i>umbhede</i>	
<i>umngane</i>		<i>izinto</i>	
<i>ingane</i>		<i>amagama</i>	
<i>izimbali</i>		<i>umama</i>	
<i>izinyane</i>		<i>izinyo</i>	
<i>imibuzo</i>		<i>isiphuzo</i>	
<i>amadoda</i>		<i>izithombe</i>	
<i>abantu</i>		<i>amabhandishi</i>	
<i>isandla</i>		<i>ijezi</i>	
<i>intombi</i>		<i>izinsuku</i>	
<i>umunwe</i>		<i>izindlebe</i>	
<i>izambane</i>		<i>unesi</i>	
<i>umZulu</i>		<i>inhliziyo</i>	
<i>imizimba</i>		<i>odokotela</i>	
<i>iplasta</i>		<i>iswidi</i>	
<i>isiguli</i>		<i>umfana</i>	

ISIFUNDO 12: THE USAGE OF ZULU NOUNS AS SUBJECTS IN SENTENCES (POSITIVE & NEGATIVE)

The usage of nouns as subjects in sentences

- When nouns function as subjects in sentences and appear together with verbs, they must be linked to the verbs.
- This linking takes place by means of specific concords known as subject concords
- Subject nouns can never appear in Zulu sentences without subject concords linking them to the verbs.

Noun classes and subject concords:

Noun class	Positive subject concord	Negative subject concord
class 1 <i>um(u)-</i>	<i>u-</i>	<i>aka-</i>
class 2 <i>aba-</i>	<i>ba-</i>	<i>aba-</i>
class 1a <i>u-</i>	<i>u-</i>	<i>aka-</i>
class 2a <i>o-</i>	<i>ba-</i>	<i>aba-</i>
class 3 <i>um(u)-</i>	<i>u-</i>	<i>awu-</i>
class 4 <i>imi-</i>	<i>i-</i>	<i>ayi-</i>
class 5 <i>i(li)-</i>	<i>li-</i>	<i>ali-</i>
class 6 <i>ama-</i>	<i>a-</i>	<i>awa-</i>

class 7	<i>isi-</i>	<i>si-</i>	<i>asi-</i>
class 8	<i>izi-</i>	<i>zi-</i>	<i>azi-</i>
class 9	<i>in-/ im-</i>	<i>i-</i>	<i>ayi-</i>
class 10	<i>izin-/ izim-</i>	<i>zi-</i>	<i>azi-</i>
class 11	<i>u(lu)-</i>	<i>lu-</i>	<i>alu-</i>
class 14	<i>ubu-</i>	<i>bu-</i>	<i>abu-</i>
class 15	<i>uku-</i>	<i>ku-</i>	<i>aku-</i>

- When nouns function as subjects in sentences and appear together with verbs, they must be linked to the verbs.
- This linking takes place by means of specific concords known as subject concords
- Subject nouns can never appear in Zulu sentences without subject concords linking them to the verbs.

Noun classes and subject concords:

- To construct sentences with subject nouns and verbs in Zulu, all the rules which were discussed in respect of the present tense, future tense, past tense, and stative tense positive and negative constructions have to be taken into account and applied.
- The concords for I/We/You (plural)/He/She/They which you are familiar with by now, will simply be replaced in all your sentences with the subject noun and their specific compulsory subject concords.

REVISION OF THE TENSES IN ZULU

Present tense positive subject concord + YA + ACTION → -A

1. I am ill. *Mina ngi + ya + gula*

Ngiyagula.

Future tense positive subject concord + ZO + ACTION → -A

2. Will you (plural) wait? *Nina ni + zo + linda na?*

Nizolinda na?

Past tense positive subject concord + ACTION → -ILE/-E

3. She worked. *Yena u + sebez + ile*

Usebenzile

Stative tense positive subject concord + ACTION → STATE OF BEING

4. We are tired. *Thina si + diniwe*

Sidiniwe.

SENTENCES IN THE PRESENT TENSE

Positive statements

Construction 1

- Nothing (no word) follows the verb / action

subject noun positive s/concord + ya + verb

Example:

The children are ill.

Izingane ziyagula.

Construction 2

A word follows after the verb / action.

Subject noun positive s/concord + verb object/adverb

Example:

The patient needs help.

Isiguli sidinga usizo.

SENTENCES IN THE FUTURE TENSE**Positive statements****Construction:**

subject noun positive s/concord + zo + verb

Example:

The men will return.

= *Amadoda azobuya.*

SENTENCES IN THE PAST TENSE**Positive statements**

Construction 1: nothing follows after the verb/action.

Subject noun positive s/concord + verb ending on -ile.

Example:

The pills helped.

Amaphilisi asizile.

Construction 2: A word follows after the verb / action.

Subject noun positive s/concord + verb ending on -e object/adverb.

Example:

The nurse brought the x-rays.

Unesi ulethe ama-eksireyi.

SENTENCES IN THE STATIVE TENSE

Positive statements

Construction: subject noun positive s/concord + stative verb

Example:

The people are drunk.

Abantu badakiwe.

The girl is pregnant.

Intombi ikhulelwe.

REVISION – THE TENSES – NEGATIVE CONSTRUCTIONS

Present tense negative subject concord + YA + ACTION → -I

1. I am not ill. Mina Angi + guli

Angiguli.

Future tense negative subject concord + ZU + ACTION → -A

2. Will you (plural) not wait? Nina Ani + zu + linda na?

Anizulinda na?

Past tense negative subject concord + ACTION → -ANGA

3. She did not work. Yena Aka + sebenz + anga.

Akasebenzanga.

Stative tense negative subject concord + STATE OF BEING → unchanged.

4. We are not tired. Thina Asi + diniwe

Asidiniwe.

NEGATIVE SENTENCES IN THE PRESENT TENSE

Construction

subject noun negative s/concord + verb ending on -i.

Example:

The children are not ill.

Izingane aziguli.

The patient does not need help.

Isiguli asidingi usizo.

NEGATIVE SENTENCES IN THE FUTURE TENSE

Construction:

subject noun negative s/concord + zu + verb ending on a

Example:

The men will not return.

Amadoda awazubuya.

The boy will not drink the medicine.

Umfana akazuphuza umuthi.

NEGATIVE SENTENCES IN THE PAST TENSE

Construction:

subject noun negative s/concord + verb ending on –anga.

Example:

The pills did not help.

Amaphilisi awasizanga.

The nurse did not bring the x-rays.

Unesi akalethanga ama-eksireyi.

NEGATIVE SENTENCES IN THE STATIVE TENSE

Construction:

subject noun negative s/concord + stative verb (unchanged)

Example:

The people are not drunk.

Abantu abadakiwe.

The girl is not pregnant.

Intombi ayikhulelwe.

UMSEBENZI WASEKHAYA (Homework 10)

Complete the sentences in column A by filling in the correct positive subject concords.

Provide the negative constructions of these sentences in column B.

COLUMN A - POSITIVE SENTENCES	COLUMN B - NEGATIVE SENTENCES
<i>Abantwana __yakhala.</i>	<i>Abantwana _____.</i>
<i>Umuthi __phelile.</i>	<i>Umuthi _____.</i>
<i>Isivakashi __zofika kusasa.</i>	<i>Isivakashi _____ kusasa.</i>
<i>Intombi __limele kabi.</i>	<i>Intombi _____ kabi.</i>
<i>Amaphoyisa __zodubula.</i>	<i>Amaphoyisa _____.</i>
<i>Izingane __dle amaswidi.</i>	<i>Izingane _____ amaswidi.</i>
<i>Umama __zobhaka ikhekhe.</i>	<i>Umama _____ ikhekhe.</i>
<i>Odokotela __yakwazi ukukhuluma isiZulu.</i>	<i>Odokotela _____ ukukhuluma isiZulu.</i>
<i>Ihembe __hlanzekile.</i>	<i>Ihembe _____.</i>
<i>Umfazi __yavuma.</i>	<i>Umfana _____.</i>
<i>Indoda __funa ukuhamba manje.</i>	<i>Indoda _____ ukuhamba manje.</i>
<i>Izikole __zovala ngeviki elizayo.</i>	<i>Izikole _____ ngeviki elizayo.</i>

<i>Ikhehla __ nobuhlungu.</i>	<i>Ikhehla _____.</i>
<i>Umfundi __ zamile.</i>	<i>Umfundi _____.</i>

ISIFUNDO 13 (PART A) THE ADJECTIVE

An adjective is a word that describes a noun.

A list of Adjectival stems:

- nye (some/ other, one)
- bili (two)
- thathu (three)
- ne (four)
- hlanu (five)
- khulu (big, great)
- ncane (small, young)
- ningi (much, many)
- hle (pretty, beautiful)
- bi (bad, ugly, evil)
- dala (old)
- sha (new)
- de (tall, long)
- fishane (short)
- ngaki (how many?)

THE RELATIVE (ordinary adjectives)

A relative is another type of word which qualifies a noun or pronoun. In its function it is like an adjective and a possessive. However, adjectives, possessives and relatives must be classified separately because they employ different concords.

The following are a few of the more commonly used relative stems:

- nzima* (heavy, difficult)
- buhlungu* (painful)
- mbalwa* (-few)
- lula* (light/easy)
- ngcono* (better)
- manyama* (black)
- mhlophe* (white)
- mpunga* (grey)
- mpofu* (poor/dun)
- luhlaza* (green, raw)
- nsundu* (brown)
- munyu* (sour, acid)
- bukhali* (sharp, greedy)
- manzi* (wet, damp)
- makhaza* (cold)
- lukhuni* (difficult, hard)
- mnandi* (nice, pleasant)
- qotho* (honest)
- buthuntu* (blunt)
- phuzi* (yellow)
- mabalabala* (colourful)

ISIFUNDO 13: (PART B) ZULU ADJECTIVES – THEIR USAGE IN SENTENCES

Zulu adjectives – used predicatively in the present tense Zulu.

When adjectives are used PREDICATIVELY in English, they will appear BEHIND the nouns which they are describing. The sentences will be translated with an IS or ARE – and they will be regarded as full / complete sentences.

*Umfana **mkhulu*** (the boy **is** big)
*Umuthi **muhle*** (the tree **is** pretty)
*Amahhashi **mancane*** (the horses **are** small)

When Zulu adjectives, regardless of which group they belong to, are used PREDICATIVELY in present tense sentences, they will just like their English counterparts appear BEHIND the nouns which they are describing, and the sentences will be directly translated with an IS or ARE right in between the noun and the adjective. These sentences will also be regarded as full / complete sentences, like they are in English.

A. Sentences in which VIP adjectives are used predicatively.

CONSTRUCTION FOR THE PRESENT TENSE

noun followed by adjective concord + Adjective

An adjective concord is required as translation for the word “IS / ARE” though whenever a VIP adjective is used in the Zulu construction.

✓ The form of the adjective concord is always determined by the class prefix of the preceding noun which is being described.

✓ The adjective concord and the VIP adjective are glued to one another and are written as one word (not separately as is the case in English).

CLASS NO.	FULL CLASS PREFIX	ADJECTIVE CONCORD
1	<i>um(u)-</i>	<i>mu-</i>
1a	<i>u-</i>	<i>mu-</i>
2	<i>aba-</i>	<i>ba-</i>
2a	<i>o-</i>	<i>ba-</i>
3	<i>um(u)-</i>	<i>mu-</i>
4	<i>imi-</i>	<i>mi-</i>
5	<i>i(li)-</i>	<i>li-</i>
6	<i>ama-</i>	<i>ma-</i>
7	<i>isi-</i>	<i>si-</i>
8	<i>izi-</i>	<i>zin-/ zim-</i>
9	<i>in-/ im-</i>	<i>in-/im-</i>
10	<i>izin-/izim-</i>	<i>zin-zim-</i>
11	<i>u(lu)-</i>	<i>lu-</i>
14	<i>ubu-</i>	<i>bu-</i>
15	<i>uku-</i>	<i>ku-</i>

The adjective concords for the FOUR PRONOUNS I & WE & YOU & YOU PLURAL and how to figure them out too:

✓ Write down the subject concords you know for all four the pronouns, namely NGI-, SI-, U- and BA-

FOUR PRONOUNS	ADJECTIVE CONCORDS
I	<i>NGIMU</i>
WE	<i>SIMU</i>
YOU	<i>UMU</i>
YOU (PL)	<i>NIBA</i>

A few explanatory notes on problematic adjective concords

Classes 1 and 3 / I and You

Sometimes the full form MU- is used and sometimes this concord shortens to M- only!

When the adjective concords of the above-mentioned classes and people are used in front of adjectives which are short (i.e. adjectives which consist of only one syllable), the full form of the adjective concord, namely MU- will be used.

Examples:

You are beautiful.	<i>(Wena) umuhle.</i>
The teacher is tall.	<i>Uthisha mude.</i>
The work is bad.	<i>Umsebenzi mubi.</i>

When the adjective concords of the above-mentioned classes and people are used in front of adjectives which are long (i.e., adjectives which consist of two syllables or more), the shortened form of the adjective concord, namely M- will be used (i.e. the U that appears in MU will be deleted).

Examples:

You are short.	<i>(Wena) umfi-sha-ne.</i>
The doctor is old.	<i>Udokotela mda-la.</i>
The machine is big.	<i>Umshini mkhu-lu.</i>

Classes 8 and 10

Sometimes the form ZIM- is used and sometimes the form ZIN- is used.

Class 9

Sometimes the form IM- is used and sometimes the form IN- is used.

The above-mentioned classes all have two forms of adjective concords.

When adjectives which start on B- or F- (only three of them, namely BI, BILI and FISHANE) are used to describe nouns from these classes, the adjective concords

containing the nasal M (i.e., IM- and ZIM-) will be used.

Examples:

The girl is short. *Intombi imFishane.*

The wishes are two. *Izifiso zimBili.*

The problems are bad. *Izinkinga zimBi.*

In front of all the other adjectives, the adjective concords containing the nasal N (i.e. IN- and ZIN-) will be used.

Examples:

The girl is tall. *Intombi inDe.*

The wishes are three. *Izifiso zinThathu.*

The problems are big. *Izinkinga zinKhulu.*

A few example sentences:

✓ The flowers (izimbali) are beautiful (-hle)

Izimbali = class 10 → class prefix = IZIM-: adjective concord = ZIN / ZIM

→ *Izimbali ZINhle* (ZIN because the adjective starts on N)

✓ The wound (isilonda) is ugly (-bi)

Isilonda = class 7 → class prefix = ISI-: adjective concord = SI

→ *Isilonda SIbi*

✓ The clinic (ikililiki) is old (-dala)

Ikililiki = class 5 → class prefix = ILI-: adjective concord = LI

→ *Ikililiki LI dala*

✓ The children (abantwana) are small (-ncane)

Abantwana = class 2 → class prefix = ABA-: adjective concord = BA

→ *Abantwana BAncane*

✓ You (wena) are short (-fishane)

Wena = pronoun singular →: adjective concord = UMU / UM

→ **Wena UMfishane** (UM because the adjective is long)

B. Sentences in which RELATIVES are used predicatively.

CONSTRUCTION FOR THE PRESENT TENSE

noun followed by subject concord + Relative

✓ A subject concord is required as translation for the word “IS / ARE” though whenever an ORDINARY adjective is used in the Zulu construction.

✓ The form of the subject concord is always determined by the class prefix of the preceding noun which is being described.

✓ The subject concord and the ORD adjective are glued to one another and are written as one word (not separately as is the case in English).

CLASS NO.	FULL CLASS PREFIX	RELATIVE CONCORD
1	<i>um(u)-</i>	<i>u-</i>
1a	<i>u-</i>	<i>u-</i>
2	<i>aba-</i>	<i>ba-</i>
2a	<i>o-</i>	<i>ba-</i>
3	<i>um(u)-</i>	<i>u-</i>
4	<i>imi-</i>	<i>i-</i>
5	<i>i(li)-</i>	<i>li-</i>
6	<i>ama-</i>	<i>a-</i>
7	<i>isi-</i>	<i>si-</i>
8	<i>izi-</i>	<i>zi-</i>
9	<i>in-/ im-</i>	<i>i-</i>

10	<i>izin-/izim-</i>	<i>zi-</i>
11	<i>u(lu)-</i>	<i>lu-</i>
14	<i>ubu-</i>	<i>bu-</i>
15	<i>uku-</i>	<i>ku-</i>

A few example sentences:

✓ The work (umsebenzi) is difficult (-nzima)

Umsebenzi = class 3 → class prefix = UMU-: subject concord = U

→ ***Umsebenzi Unzima***

✓ Zulu (isiZulu) is easy (-lula)

IsiZulu = class 7 → class prefix = ISI-: subject concord = SI

→ ***IsiZulu Sllula***

✓ The water (amanzi) is cold (-makhaza)

Amanzi = class 6 → class prefix = AMA-: subject concord = A

→ ***Amanzi Amakhaza***

UMSEBENZI WASEKHAYA (Homework11)

Translate the following sentences containing adjectives into Zulu.

ADJECTIVES

ENGLISH

The bed is small.

The doctor is handsome.

The bandages are many.

The news is bad.

The child is big.

The patients are old.

ISIZULU

Umbhede _____.

Udokotela _____.

Amabhandishi _____.

Indaba _____.

Ingane _____.

Iziguli _____.

The visitors are two.
I am short.
How many are you (plural)?

Izivakashi _____.
Mina _____.
Nina _____.

RELATIVES

ENGLISH

The doctors are honest.
My hand hurts.
The child is better.
The water is cold.
The work is difficult.
How is your arm?
My feet hurt.
My foot is red.
The gown is white.

ISIZULU

Odokotela _____.
Isandla sami _____.
Umntwana _____.
Amanzi _____.
Umsebenzi _____.
Ingalo yakho _____?
Izinyawo zami _____.
Unyawo lwami _____.
Igawuni _____.

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